PROactive PRONUNCIATION

“Upsilon” /ʊ/ Spelling

There are various ways to spell the /ʊ/ sound, with an o, u, ou, or even oo. The double "oo" spelling adds extra difficulty as there really is no way to differentiate whether we pronounce it as /u/ “oo” vs. /ʊ/, so the speaker must memorize the words. Luckily, there are really only a handful of words spelled with the "oo" and pronounced as /ʊ/, so this will make your work a little easier.

This is an exhaustive list, so try your best to memorize these. Memorizing the upsilon sound will prevent you from getting confused with the other vowel pronunciations.

"o" pronounced as /ʊ/:

bosom	wolves
wolf	woman

“oo" pronounced as /ʊ/:

book	hood	stood
brook	hook	took
cook	look	wood
crook	rook	wool
foot	shook	
good	soot	

*the words "hoof" and "roof" can be pronounced as /u/ or /ʊ/ as both are accepted pronunciations in English

"u" pronounced as /ʊ/:

bull	butcher	pull
bullet	cushion	push
bush	full	put
butch	pudding	sugar

"ou" pronounced as /ʊ/:

could	would	should